

# Refine your prompt (self-paced)

Activity · Prompting techniques · ~20 min

## BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You've completed **Build a clear prompt**, **Explore with the AI Assistant**, and **Iterative vs single-prompt**
- ☐ The AI Assistant is open in your country's project

## WHY IT MATTERS

A good prompt is rarely the first one you write. This exercise walks through three rounds on one topic — each round adds something specific.

## How to do this

Pick **one** topic from your data and stay with it for all three rounds:

- ☐ Outliers
- ☐ Completeness
- ☐ Disruptions

Run each round in a **new** AI conversation so you see the difference from a clean slate, not as a follow-up.

## Three rounds

| Round                        | Prompt to try                                                                                                               | Ask yourself after the AI responds                          |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Start simple</b>       | <i>Create a slide about [your topic].</i>                                                                                   | What did the AI include? Would this work in a real meeting? |
| <b>2. Add context</b>        | <i>Create a slide about [topic] for a [meeting type]. Show [specific data]. Explain which regions have the most issues.</i> | Is it more specific? Does it identify priorities?           |
| <b>3. Make it actionable</b> | <i>Create a slide about [topic] for [meeting]. Compare areas — which need support? Suggest possible reasons.</i>            | Does it prioritise areas? Point toward next steps?          |

## Reflection

After all three rounds:

- Which round produced the most useful slide?
- What specifically made the final prompt more effective than the first?
- If you ran this prompt again next week, which version would you save and reuse?

## Tips

**The pattern is "what / where / when / why / who".** Round 2 typically adds *where* and *when*. Round 3 adds *why* (purpose) and *who* (audience). The first round is missing all of these.

**Save the best prompt.** Once you find a phrasing that works well, save it (or add it to your team's prompt library — see the next section) so you don't rebuild it from scratch.

## What's next

Move on to **Use a previous report as a template** for an alternative way to drive the AI: from an example you already trust.